Faith That Pleases God

Hebrews 11:1-10 (KJV)

Scripture

Hebrews 11:1-10

[1] Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen. [2] For by it the elders obtained a good report. [3] Through faith we understand that the worlds were framed by the word of God, so that things which are seen were not made of things which do appear. [4] By faith Abel offered unto God a more excellent sacrifice than Cain, by which he obtained witness that he was righteous, God testifying of his gifts: and by it he being dead yet speaketh. [5] By faith Enoch was translated that he should not see death; and was not found, because God had translated him: for before his translation he had this testimony, that he pleased God. [6] But without faith it is impossible to please him: for he that cometh to God must believe that he is, and that he is a rewarder of them that diligently seek him. [7] By faith Noah, being warned of God of things not seen as yet, moved with fear, prepared an ark to the saving of his house; by the which he condemned the world, and became heir of the righteousness which is by faith. [8] By faith Abraham, when he was called to go out into a place which he should after receive for an inheritance, obeyed; and he went out, not knowing whither he went. [9] By faith he sojourned in the land of promise, as in a strange country, dwelling in tabernacles with Isaac and Jacob, the heirs with him of the same promise: [10] For he looked for a city which hath foundations, whose builder and maker is God.

Outline

1. Faith trusts what God has said about what we cannot see

Faith is the evidence of things not _____.

Faith rests on what God has _____.

Read: Hebrews 11:1-3; 2 Corinthians 5:7; Romans 10:17

2. Without faith it is impossible to please God

Without faith it is _____ to please God.

Faith is not only knowing about God but _____ him.

Read: Hebrews 11:4-6; Romans 4:20-21; James 2:19

3. Faith obeys and keeps going

Abraham went out, not knowing _____ he went.

Faith shows itself in trusting _____.

Read: Hebrews 11:7-10; Genesis 12:1-4; Hebrews 11:13-16

Discussion questions

1. How would you explain the difference between faith and wishful thinking?

2. Why do you think the writer chose people whose stories include failures?

3. Noah and Abraham acted before they saw anything happen. Where is God asking you to trust him before you see the outcome?

4. Abraham looked for a heavenly city. How does hope for the future help us keep trusting now?

This week

Write down one promise of God that speaks to a situation you are facing (for example Philippians 4:19, Isaiah 41:10, or Romans 8:28). Read it every morning this week. Then take one concrete step of obedience that shows you are trusting it.